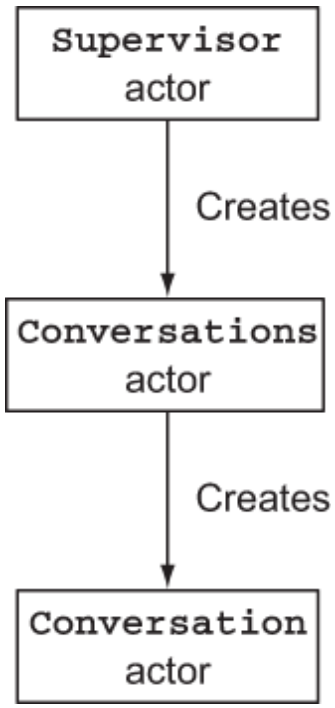


Figure 1.17 Creating actors

Designing the next behavior

State machines are a great tool for ensuring that a system executes particular actions only when it's in a specific state. Actors receive messages one at a time, which is a convenient property for implementing state machines. An actor can change how it handles incoming messages by swapping out its behavior. An actor must designate the behavior to be used for the next message it receives.

Imagine that users want to be able to close a `Conversation`. The `Conversation` starts in a started state and becomes closed when a `CloseConversation` is received. Any message that's sent to the closed `Conversation` can be ignored. The `Conversation` swaps its behavior from adding messages to itself to ignoring all messages.